

# The Caro-Kann gives a bishop a route

Opening Decisions

## THE IDEA

After 1.e4 c6 2.d4 d5, Black challenges the center while keeping the c8 bishop's diagonal open for now. That bishop's development is one reason the move ...e6 is often delayed. The c-pawn's location also influences later central breaks.

## WORKED EXAMPLE

In 3.e5 Bf5, Black develops the bishop outside the pawn chain before playing ...e6. The bishop may become a target for White's pawns, so Black must combine development with a plan for its retreat.

## TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

**What is the tradeoff in playing ...c6 before ...d5?**

## ANSWER AND REASONING

Black supports the d5 pawn, but c6 is unavailable to the b8 knight and another tempo may be needed for ...c5 later. The structure offers advantages at a cost.

## TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

**Opening choices exchange one set of conveniences for another.**